10-01 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle-School Students Be Required to Do Community Volunteer Work?

① Last month our class began a new discussion after a short **report on the morning news**: in several cities, middle schools are now **requiring every student** to do at least **twenty hours of community volunteer work** each year — cleaning a park, helping at a local library, visiting a nursing home, sorting recycling in the neighbourhood, or supporting a traffic-safety day outside a primary school. Some families welcomed the idea; others were angry, saying that children already have too little time. **Should middle-school volunteer work be a real school requirement, or should it stay completely voluntary?** I believe that a small, reasonable **requirement is a good thing** — as long as schools plan it carefully.

② The first argument for **requiring** it is simple: **volunteer work is part of education itself**, not something extra. Textbooks can teach us what society is; only **doing** can teach us how it feels. A student who spends two Saturdays sorting books in a community library sees, in person, that reading rooms do not keep themselves tidy — real people do. A student who helps an elderly neighbour for an afternoon understands, not in theory but in her own tired feet, why **respect for the elderly** is more than a slogan on a wall. These lessons cannot be learned from an exam paper.

③ Secondly, a clear requirement **makes volunteering fair**. Today, without rules, the students who do community service are usually the ones whose families **already have the time, money or connections** to arrange it — through friends, church groups or paid summer camps. Students from busy working families, or from quieter personalities, often never get a chance. When the school arranges activities for **everyone**, the child of a doctor and the child of a street-cleaner stand side by side in the same park with the same broom. This kind of equal starting line is, in itself, valuable education.

④ A third reason is **the effect on our communities**. Many public libraries, nursing homes, traffic-safety teams and animal shelters are badly understaffed on weekends. Even a small team of students — well-prepared and politely behaved — can make a real difference: a nursing home can run a Saturday-afternoon reading hour, a library can stay open an extra two hours, a primary-school crossing can have four pairs of watchful eyes instead of two. **Our towns are quietly better** when students show up.

⑤ Of course, **those who disagree have reasonable worries**. The most common one is **time**: middle-school students already sleep late and wake early, juggling maths, English,

PE, projects and tests. Forcing twenty more hours into a packed year, critics say, will only bring **exhaustion and resentment**. They are right that we must be careful. But twenty hours a year is **roughly twenty-five minutes a week** — less than one TV episode. If schools break it into a few weekend mornings and one school-holiday afternoon, almost every student can manage.

⑥ A second worry is that **required volunteering is not real volunteering**. If the school forces us to go, the argument goes, the "kindness" is not kindness at all — we are just ticking a box. There is something to this worry. But kindness is not only a feeling; it is also a **habit**. Most children do not **want** to brush their teeth at first either; after a few months of being gently required, brushing becomes natural. In the same way, being guided to help others for a few Saturdays can turn something awkward into something the student **chooses** on his own years later.

⑦ A third worry is about **safety and quality**. Sending children to random places can be risky, and badly organised volunteering — "move this pile of rocks, then go home" — teaches nothing. This, however, is not an argument against requirements; it is an argument for **good planning**. Schools should sign formal agreements with partner organisations, provide basic training, arrange safe transportation, and ask students to write a short reflection afterwards. With these steps, community service becomes a real learning programme, not a Sunday-afternoon accident.

⑧ There is also a deeper reason, one easy to forget on busy school mornings: a country is built not only by scientists, engineers and CEOs, but also by **ordinary people who are willing to help a stranger**. A society where every young person, rich or poor, has at least once **swept a park, read to an old person, or guided a small child across the street** is a society with a stronger **inner ground**. In this sense, a modest school requirement is **not a burden**; it is the country quietly teaching its next generation how to stand on its own feet and lend a hand.

⑨ My conclusion is therefore balanced but clear. Middle schools should **require** a small amount of community volunteer work — around **twenty hours a year**, divided into short, safe, well-planned activities. Students who, for serious reasons of health, family or distance, cannot take part in a given activity should be offered **alternatives**. The point is not to force every student to love every task; it is to make sure that, by the time we graduate, **every one of us has looked up from the textbook at least a few times**, and helped the real world we will soon step into.

注释： volunteer work 志愿服务；requirement 要求；nursing home 养老院；understaffed 人手不足；resentment 怨恨

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main view in this essay?

A. Middle-school students should never do community volunteer work.
B. Middle-school students should do at least a thousand hours of volunteer work every year.
C. Middle schools should require a small, reasonable amount (about twenty hours a year) of carefully planned community volunteer work.
D. Only rich students should be allowed to volunteer.

2. In Paragraph 3, what advantage of a school requirement does the writer describe?

A. It lets only the best students volunteer.
B. It makes volunteering fair: without rules, usually only students from families with time, money or connections get the chance; when the school arranges it for everyone, all students start on an equal line.
C. It earns the school more money.
D. It frees teachers from all work.

3. How does the writer reply to the worry that twenty more hours a year will exhaust students (Paragraph 5)?

A. He says exhaustion is a good thing.
B. He calculates that twenty hours a year is roughly twenty-five minutes a week — less than one TV episode — and says that with a few weekend mornings and one holiday afternoon almost every student can manage.
C. He says students should sleep less.
D. He says homework should be cancelled instead.

4. What is the writer's answer to the worry that "required volunteering is not real volunteering" (Paragraph 6)?

A. He fully agrees and gives up his position.
B. He points out that kindness is not only a feeling but also a habit — like brushing teeth, being gently required for a few Saturdays can later turn into something students choose on their own.
C. He says kindness is useless.
D. He says all school rules are wrong.

5. In the last two paragraphs, what is the writer's overall conclusion?

A. Volunteering is a waste of time.
B. Middle schools should require about twenty hours of well-planned, safe volunteer work a year, with alternatives for students in real difficulty, so that by graduation every student has at least a few times lifted his or her eyes from the textbook and helped the real world.
C. Only parents should decide, not schools.
D. Only high-school seniors should volunteer.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第①段 "small, reasonable requirement is a good thing" & 第⑨段 "require ... around twenty hours a year"
【解析】作者支持学校安排合理、少量的志愿要求。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "makes volunteering fair ... child of a doctor and the child of a street-cleaner ... same broom"
【解析】强制要求可保公平。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "twenty hours a year is roughly twenty-five minutes a week ... less than one TV episode"
【解析】作者算账说明负担不重。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "kindness is not only a feeling; it is also a habit ... turn something awkward into something the student chooses on his own"
【解析】善良亦可习惯养成。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第⑨段 "around twenty hours a year ... alternatives ... every one of us has looked up from the textbook at least a few times"
【解析】末段总结核心立场。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。